

PHYSICAL THERAPY CLINICAL NOTES

Member ID:	PPO-000007	DOB:	January 14, 1969
Patient Name:	Aaron Fitzgerald	Age:	55 years
LOB:	PPO	Service Date:	August 14, 2024

VISIT 1: INITIAL EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT (99214)

Time: 8:00 AM – 8:25 AM

CHIEF COMPLAINT

Right knee pain and functional limitation with physical therapy referral

HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS

Patient is a 55-year-old male with unilateral primary osteoarthritis of the right knee (M17.11) referred for physical therapy. Patient reports pain with ambulation and stair negotiation. He has been managing symptoms with NSAIDs and activity modification. Patient is motivated for therapy and wishes to improve functional mobility and reduce pain. No acute injury; chronic degenerative process.

PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

Right Knee Inspection:	Mild effusion, normal skin color, no erythema
Palpation:	Tenderness over medial joint line, crepitus with passive ROM
ROM:	Extension 0°, Flexion 105° (reduced)
Strength:	Quadriceps 4+/5, hamstring 4+/5 (guarding due to pain)
Special Tests:	McMurray test negative, Lachman test negative

ASSESSMENT (MEDICAL DECISION MAKING)

Patient with chronic right knee osteoarthritis presents for PT evaluation and treatment. Diagnosis confirmed by history and physical examination. Patient is a good candidate for conservative management via therapeutic exercise and activity. Pain level 6/10 at rest, 8/10 with activity. Functional limitations include difficulty ascending/descending stairs, reduced walking tolerance (limited to 15 minutes). Prognosis: Good with consistent therapy participation.

PLAN

Proceed with physical therapy evaluation and treatment. Goals: (1) Reduce knee pain to 4/10 or less; (2) Improve knee ROM to 115° flexion; (3) Improve quadriceps strength to 5/5; (4) Increase walking tolerance to 30 minutes. Frequency: 1-2x/week for 6-8 weeks. Modalities: Therapeutic exercise, therapeutic activities, stretching, and patient education.

VISIT 1 CONTINUED: THERAPEUTIC EXERCISE SESSION (97110)

Time: 8:25 AM – 8:35 AM (10 minutes of exercises)

Therapeutic Exercises Performed:

- Seated knee extension: 3 sets x 10 reps with 1 lb ankle weight (right leg)
- Standing hip abduction (lateral leg raise): 3 sets x 10 reps
- Supine quadriceps sets (isometric): 3 sets x 15 reps, 5-second hold
- Supine hamstring curls: 3 sets x 10 reps

- Standing calf raises (bilateral): 3 sets x 12 reps

Patient Response: Patient tolerated exercises well. Mild discomfort (3/10) during knee extension but acceptable. Patient demonstrated good form and effort. Encouraged continued performance of exercises at home.

VISIT 1 CONTINUED: THERAPEUTIC ACTIVITIES (97530)

Time: 8:35 AM – 8:50 AM (15 minutes of activities)

Functional Training & Therapeutic Activities:

- Sit-to-stand training: 5 repetitions from chair at various heights (18" and 16")
- Stair negotiation training: Step-ups on 4" step, 8 repetitions, bilateral rail support
- Gait training: Walking with cueing for symmetrical weight distribution, 5 minutes in clinic hallway
- Home safety education: Discussed proper body mechanics, use of handrails, footwear recommendations
- Home exercise program instruction: Patient provided written instructions for daily exercises

Patient Response: Patient demonstrated improvement in stair mechanics during session. Gait symmetry improved with cueing. Patient verbalized understanding of home program. Provided patient with printed handout of HEP.

VISIT 2: BRIEF FOLLOW-UP ASSESSMENT (99213)

Time: 8:50 AM – 8:58 AM (8 minutes)

CHIEF COMPLAINT

Follow-up post-PT session, assess pain and tolerance

BRIEF HPI

Patient completing first session of PT. Tolerated exercises and activities well. Pain currently 5/10 post-exercise. No adverse events. Patient reports feeling optimistic about therapy.

ASSESSMENT & PLAN

Patient doing well. Continue with PT as planned. Advised on use of ice after home exercises. Will monitor progress. Patient to call with any concerns. Return for next PT session in 2-3 days. No complications noted.

VISIT 3: REASSESSMENT & PROGRESS EVALUATION (99215)

Time: 8:58 AM – 9:30 AM (30-minute comprehensive reassessment)

CHIEF COMPLAINT

Reassessment for progress on PT goals; modification of treatment plan

DETAILED HISTORY

Patient reports that after initial PT session this morning, he has already noticed improvement in pain during stair negotiation. Resting pain 6/10 (slightly improved from 8/10 with activity baseline). Compliance with home exercise program expected. No new complaints or complications. Motivated to continue therapy.

COMPREHENSIVE PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

Right Knee Inspection:	Effusion appears reduced compared to start of day
Palpation:	Tenderness at medial joint line, improved from initial assessment
ROM:	Extension 0°, Flexion 108° (2° improvement from initial 105°)
Strength:	Quadriceps 4+/5, hamstring 4+/5 (improvement in quad strength with less guarding)
Gait:	Improved symmetry, reduced antalgic pattern
Functional:	Sit-to-stand slightly improved, stair climbing improved

ASSESSMENT (MEDICAL DECISION MAKING - HIGH COMPLEXITY)

Patient demonstrates positive early response to PT intervention. Pain reduction and functional improvement noted within first 2 hours of treatment. Strength improving; ROM improving; gait mechanics improving. No complications or adverse events. Patient highly motivated and compliant. Reassessment of treatment plan warranted to progress intensity and complexity of exercises. Prognosis remains good with continued participation. Plan modification recommended to address specific deficits.

MODIFIED PLAN & RECOMMENDATIONS

Continued Treatment Goals: (1) Reduce pain to 3/10 or less; (2) Improve knee ROM to 120° flexion; (3) Achieve quadriceps 5/5 strength; (4) Normalize gait pattern; (5) Return to stair climbing without difficulty.

Modifications to Treatment: Increase exercise resistance to 2-3 lbs; add step-up training to 6" height; add standing balance exercises; continue gait training with increased distances. Frequency maintained at 1-2x/week. Estimated duration: 6-8 weeks for full functional recovery.

Patient Education: Reinforced importance of consistent HEP compliance. Discussed pain management strategies. Recommended ice application after exercises. Encouraged gradual activity advancement. Patient verbalized full understanding.

CLAIMS SUMMARY - AUGUST 14, 2024

Service Code	Description	Time	Status
99214	Office visit, established patient, moderate MDM	8:00-8:25 (25 min)	Completed
97110	Therapeutic exercises	8:25-8:35 (10 min)	Completed
97530	Therapeutic activities & gait training	8:35-8:50 (15 min)	Completed
99213	Brief follow-up visit, low MDM	8:50-8:58 (8 min)	Completed
99215	Office visit, reassessment, high MDM	8:58-9:30 (32 min)	Completed

Clinical Notes Completed: August 14, 2024 | Total Service Time: 90 minutes | Diagnosis: M17.11 (Right Knee OA)